Besides, this policy meant that future defectors continued to have an incentive to shift their allegiance.[78]

Table 16.1: Defectors from Other Parties are Crucial to the BJP's Expansion, Became Key Ministers

State	*Ministers*	*BJP Ministers*	*BJP Ministers Who were Earlier in Other Parties*	*Percentage of Bjp Ministers Who were Earlier in Other Parties*
Assam	18	12	6	50%
Tripura	8	6	3	50%
Nagaland	11	6	3	50%
Manipur	12	5	4	80%
Meghalaya	12	1	1	100%
Arunachal Pradesh	11	11	11	100%

Source: Author's analysis of ministerial lists as displayed on respective state government home pages on 10 May 2020[79]

Nagaland Deputy Chief Minister Yanthungo Patton had been home minister in the previous Naga People's Front (NPF) government before he resigned and joined the BJP just before the March 2018 assembly election.[80] Three of the BJP's six ministers in the state (50 per cent) had also defected from other parties, as did the former chief minister, Jacob Zhimomi.[81] Similarly, as many as seven of the BJP's twelve legislators in the state had previously been MLAs or ministers in other parties.[82] In Manipur too, the BJP's first chief minister, Nongthombam Birendra Singh, had defected from the Congress in 2016 and had once been a Congress minister. More than a dozen other senior leaders from both the Congress and the Trinamool Congress defected in the lead-up to Manipur's 2017 election. Most of them were given BJP tickets to contest and many were rewarded with ministerial berths.[83] As many as 80 per cent of